

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Analyst | Incident Response Lead | Microsoft Sentinel | Detection Engineering | Cloud Security

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)-certified Senior Cyber Security Analyst with over five years of experience leading cyber security incidents operationally, technically and commercially from end-to-end within complex enterprise environments. I act as a senior technical subject matter expert across incident response, detection engineering, cloud security and threat and vulnerability management, and I am highly experienced in providing calm, structured communications to both technical teams and senior leadership throughout the incident lifecycle. My Microsoft security expertise spans Microsoft Sentinel, Kusto Query Language (KQL) detection engineering, Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft Defender XDR and Azure security, and I have a strong track record in building and maturing Cyber Defence capabilities across large-scale environments. I am seeking a highly visible role in a growing global Cyber Defence function where I can shape security operations and drive resilience across a complex international environment.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **SIEM and Detection Engineering:** Microsoft Sentinel; Kusto Query Language (KQL) rule authoring and tuning; CrowdStrike Next-Gen SIEM; detection library development; MITRE ATT&CK mapping
- **XDR and EDR Platforms:** Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE); Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI); Microsoft Defender XDR; CrowdStrike Falcon (Prevent, Insight, Discover) - Expert
- **SOAR and Automation:** Microsoft Sentinel automated playbooks; SOAR workflow development; PowerShell scripting; security automation
- **Incident Response Leadership:** End-to-end incident lifecycle (triage, severity assessment, containment, eradication, recovery, post-incident review); incident bridge call leadership; P1 to P4 coordination; NIST 800-61
- **Cloud Security:** Microsoft Azure security; secure-by-design principles; Microsoft Entra ID (formerly Azure Active Directory); Conditional Access; Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA)
- **Threat and Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io; AppCheck; Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS); Nessus; risk-prioritised remediation
- **Identity Governance:** Microsoft Entra ID; BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM); MFA; Single Sign-On (SSO); Okta
- **Stakeholder Engagement:** Technical and commercial impact assessment; structured senior leadership communication during high-severity incidents
- **Frameworks and Standards:** NIST CSF; CIS Controls; ISO 27001; Cyber Essentials Plus; MITRE ATT&CK

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer

March 2025 - Present

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

- Lead cyber security incidents end-to-end, acting as the senior technical subject matter expert across incident triage, severity assessment, response coordination, containment, eradication, recovery and post-incident improvement activities
- Chair incident bridge calls for Priority 1 to Priority 4 security events, coordinating technical and business stakeholders throughout the incident lifecycle and assessing technical, operational and commercial impact under pressure
- Provide clear, calm and structured communications to both technical teams and senior leadership during high-severity incidents, ensuring informed decision-making at every stage

- Engineer and maintain Microsoft Sentinel detection rules using Kusto Query Language (KQL), mapping coverage to MITRE ATT&CK Tactics, Techniques and Procedures (TTPs) to improve proactive threat detection and reduce false positives
- Develop and operationalise SOAR automation playbooks in Microsoft Sentinel, automating triage, notification and response workflows to reduce manual effort and accelerate detection-to-response cycles
- Operate Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) and Microsoft Defender XDR for real-time threat hunting, alert investigation and security event correlation across a complex multi-site environment
- Manage threat and vulnerability management lifecycle using Tenable.io, AppCheck and Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), driving risk-prioritised remediation aligned to organisational risk appetite
- Administer Azure security controls, Microsoft Entra ID Conditional Access policies and Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) to embed secure-by-design principles across cloud and hybrid environments
- Conduct root cause analysis following security incidents, ensuring lessons learned are embedded into operational processes, detection coverage and security controls
- Operate CrowdStrike Falcon (Prevent, Insight, Discover) alongside Microsoft Sentinel to provide layered, comprehensive threat visibility across all endpoints
- Manage Privileged Access Management (PAM) via BeyondTrust, applying least-privilege principles to reduce the blast radius of identity-based attacks
- Contribute to ISO 27001, NIST CSF, CIS Controls and Cyber Essentials Plus compliance, supporting audits and continuous security control improvement

Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

March 2022 - March 2025

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

- Deployed and onboarded Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) across 8,000 users, establishing unified XDR visibility across endpoint and identity attack surfaces within a complex higher education environment
- Developed and maintained Microsoft Sentinel KQL detection rules and analytical queries, continuously refining signal quality and reducing alert fatigue
- Performed day-to-day alert triage and security event investigation across SIEM environments, escalating Priority 1 incidents and leading structured response activities aligned to NIST 800-61
- Conducted threat hunting across endpoint, identity and cloud data sources using MITRE ATT&CK methodology to identify stealthy and persistent threats not surfaced by automated detection
- Managed cloud security controls in Azure Active Directory (now Microsoft Entra ID), including Conditional Access policy management, MFA enforcement and identity governance
- Supported vulnerability management using Tenable.io and Nessus, producing risk-prioritised remediation recommendations for infrastructure and application owners
- Contributed to security automation and SOAR playbook development, streamlining recurring operational workflows
- Maintained and tuned SIEM detection logic to improve coverage against emerging threat actor TTPs, referencing the MITRE ATT&CK framework

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

February 2021 - March 2022

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech)

- Supported cyber security operations and incident investigation in a cloud-native Software-as-a-Service (SaaS) FinTech environment, contributing to alert triage and security event analysis
- Implemented identity and access management controls, network security configuration and endpoint protection measures for a distributed, cloud-first workforce
- Assisted with vulnerability assessment activities, supporting remediation tracking and security posture reporting
- Contributed to security policy development and regulatory compliance activities, including data protection and General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR) controls
- Supported IT infrastructure quality assurance, maintaining documentation and process controls for security and compliance

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Led the enterprise-wide deployment of Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) across 8,000 users, delivering full XDR visibility across endpoint and identity attack surfaces in a complex higher education environment
- Engineered a library of Microsoft Sentinel KQL detection rules aligned to the MITRE ATT&CK framework, improving detection coverage and reducing mean time to detect for Priority 1 and Priority 2 security incidents
- Operationalised SOAR automation playbooks in Microsoft Sentinel, reducing manual triage effort for recurring high-volume alert categories and measurably accelerating incident response
- Led end-to-end incident response for multiple high-severity security events, including leading incident bridge calls, coordinating stakeholders across technical and business functions and driving root cause analysis and improvement activities
- Achieved Cyber Essentials Plus certification and maintained alignment to ISO 27001, providing independently verified evidence of robust security controls to senior leadership and external auditors

EDUCATION

- **M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering**
- **B.Sc. Chemical Engineering**

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
- CompTIA Security+
- Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
- CompTIA A+
- Google IT Support Professional Certificate

References available on request | Hybrid/Remote (London/UK)